Pallet Truck



Category: **Retail, Logistics & Warehouse** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 6 labs

Covers these lab items: Battery Operated Pallet Truck; BOPT; Hand Operated Pallet Truck; HOPT

What it is used for

A pallet truck moves palletised goods over suitable warehouse floors using manual or battery-powered lifting. Correct load placement, route checks, and controlled movement help prevent crushing injuries and load instability.

Main parts

- Forks support the pallet and its load.
- Hydraulic lifting unit raises and lowers the forks.
- Handle controls steering and lifting functions on manual models.
- Drive controls operate travel and lifting on powered models.
- Wheels and rollers allow movement across the floor.
- Battery and charger supply power on battery-operated models.
- Load rating plate identifies the permitted capacity.

Before you start

1. Read the operating instructions and confirm the pallet truck suits the load and route.
2. Inspect forks, wheels, rollers, handle, hydraulic unit, controls, battery, and brakes where fitted.
3. Check the load weight and ensure it is within the rated capacity.
4. Confirm the pallet is intact and the goods are stable and secured.
5. Clear the route of obstacles, spills, people, and uneven surfaces.
6. For powered models, check battery charge and confirm the emergency stop works.

How to use

1. Position the pallet truck squarely in front of the pallet on level ground.
2. Lower the forks and insert them fully into the pallet openings.
3. Use the manual handle or approved powered controls to raise the pallet just enough for travel.
4. Check the load remains stable and does not block safe visibility.
5. Move at a controlled walking pace and keep the route clear.
6. Use the designated handle and controls to steer without sudden turns or stops.
7. Keep the load low while travelling and avoid slopes beyond the equipment's limits.
8. Stop on level ground and lower the pallet fully before withdrawing the forks.
9. Park with forks lowered and isolate the power on battery-operated models as instructed.
10. Return the truck to its storage or charging area and report faults.

⚠ Safety

- Never exceed the rated capacity or carry people on the pallet truck.
- Keep feet away from the wheels and forks, especially during turning and lowering.
- Never stand beneath raised forks or between the truck and a fixed object.
- Do not ride on a pallet truck unless it is specifically designed for riding.
- Avoid steep slopes, sharp turns, and sudden braking with a raised load.
- Stop using equipment with hydraulic leaks, damaged forks, faulty controls, or unstable wheels.

Care & storage

- Clean the forks, wheels, and handle after use and remove debris safely.
- Inspect hydraulic leaks, rollers, wheels, controls, and battery connectors regularly.
- Charge batteries only with the compatible charger in the designated ventilated area.
- Arrange authorised maintenance and report defects before returning the truck to service.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Using a damaged pallet or carrying a load beyond the rated capacity.
- Travelling with the load raised higher than necessary.
- Turning sharply or moving too quickly in crowded aisles.
- Leaving powered equipment on or parking with forks raised.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.

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